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Subject: [External] AI Action Plan
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To Whom It May Concern (which should be all of us, because AI is a tool which has rapidly devolved into a mess which will have wide-reaching negative impacts for us all if we are not careful),

AI was at one time thought to be perhaps the future of technology. It was a new, shiny tool with implications for the future of health, medicine, safety, public security, and many other things.

Now, it's some bastardized idea of what it once was, and at its core requires theft in order to keep the proverbial lights on. And really, that's what is at the heart of this issue. AI cannot exist without stealing, scraping, and regurgitating poor renditions of copyrighted work. That in and of itself is enough to outline why it has to be stopped. If the companies creating AI 'chat bots', image and video generators get to ignore copyright law then why does every other citizen and business have to abide by that law? Why has the exception been made for AI?

Are we willing to allow theft of the highest degree in order to force this tool down the throats of every man woman and child in the United States and beyond? Despite general widespread public disdain for AI, it now exists in many online shopping sites, social media platforms, and even on the search engines we use every day (where they regularly spit out inaccurate and at times downright harmful information). It is now not only prevalent, but invasive.

Every work meeting starts with a warning that your every word is being transcribed using AI - but when you read the transcripts back they're wrong.

Nobody is benefitting from AI. Students are using it to avoid doing their work, employers are using it to skip over every qualified candidate they receive a job application from, and companies are using it to avoid having to answer directly to their consumers. Social media and advertising agencies are using AI to avoid hiring real people to act in their commercials or make their graphics. Bad actors are using AI to fool the AI-ignorant masses (oftentimes our older members of society) that fake images are real, sparking mass outrage over something that never happened.

And let's not forget the unregulated creation of deepfakes.

To push a tool that is so broken it's harmful, full steam ahead, has quite frankly been the most idiotic thing I've seen in a long long time. Name another instance where the government has encouraged the widespread use and normalization of a tool that we knew was not only broken, but inherently harmful. Did it turn out well? I cannot over-exaggerate the harm AI has done and will continue to do. To our lives, our arts, our students, our workforce, our planet, and our future.

We need to put it down.

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